

THE CLIMBING BIBLE

PRACTICAL
EXERCISES

MARTIN MOBRÅTEN &
STIAN CHRISTOPHERSEN

Translated by Bjørn Sætнан





THE **CLIMBING** PRACTICAL EXERCISES **BIBLE**

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ABOUT THE AUTHORS



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Martin Moberaten has a master's degree in civil engineering, has climbed for over 20 years, has been an athlete on the Norwegian national team and is a former Nordic champion in climbing. He has climbed extensively outdoors and has redpointed several routes graded F8c+ and boulder problems up to Font 8c. Martin has coached the Norwegian Climbing Federation's youth recruits and many of the stronger juniors in the Trondheim community for the past ten years. Martin works daily with climbing courses, route setting and facilitating climbing both indoors and outdoors.

Stian Christophersen is a physiotherapist and coach, has climbed for over 20 years, has been an athlete on the national team and was the 2009 Norwegian bouldering champion. He has also climbed extensively outdoors and has first ascents of routes up to F8c and boulder problems up to Font 8b+. Stian is a former national team coach in climbing and is a personal trainer for several of Norway's best climbers. He has also been responsible for the Norwegian Climbing Federation's education of coaches, and in addition to running his own physiotherapy practice he educates the next generation of coaches at both a national and international level.



PHOTO: SIGRID BAUMBERGER

Jarl Gåsvær taking in the view from Vesteggen (the West Ridge) on Stetind, Norway.

MARTIN MOBRÅTEN & STIAN CHRISTOPHERSEN
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Translated by Bjørn Sætnan

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PHOTO: RYAN WATERS

'FOR MANY YEARS I DIDN'T TRAIN, I JUST CLIMBED. IT TOOK YEARS FOR ME TO REALISE I HAD TO TRAIN TO IMPROVE.'

HOOKED

FOREWORD BY CECILIE SKOG

I'M RELISHING THE sound of metallic jingle jangle as I cram the 14 quickdraws into my backpack, where the rope is already waiting. I remove the now flat sandwich I forgot to eat earlier, and replace it with my shoes and chalk bag – which lets out one last puff of dust for the day. I cinch my backpack up tight and blow on my sore fingertips. My skin has worn thin after numerous attempts. *Next time*, I think to myself as I throw the backpack on to my shoulders. *Next time I'll send it.*

The backpack feels lighter than on the way in. So do my feet. And head, I think. Thoughts of this and that have been replaced by moves and movements. A warm sense of community reminds me of who I am. My body is tired and numb. The world is weightless and anything is possible. *Next time.*

And to think, I don't need to climb sky-high or haul a sled to the end of the world to experience this feeling of trembling satisfaction. The feeling of spring, and the onset of an everlasting summer. I don't even need the euphoria of being newly in love. What is it with climbing? Why should this activity come with a red warning label: 'Highly addictive.' Why do we get so addicted?

For many years I didn't train, I just climbed. It took years for me to realise I had to train to improve. I learned how to warm up, and I got pushed outside of my comfort zone – provoking reactions like 'What? I'm going to lead a hard route without first practising it on a top rope? What if I fall?' Falling on lead could at that time be classified as my greatest fear. Perhaps only second to spiders. With a mouth full of sand I trembled upwards, quickdraw after quickdraw, and somewhere along the way I took my first fall on lead. I let out a primal scream, but was laughing hysterically on the inside. My fears drifted out from my ears like smoke from a peace pipe. It was liberating.

I decided on my first goal as a sport climber. My goal was to climb Norwegian grade 8- (approx. French 7b). But more importantly, to climb 8- before Aleksander Gamme. On a crisp autumn day, after lots of training, trying and failing, I finally sent *Prosessen*, 7+/8- (approx. French 7a+) at Hauktjern. I raised the flag and thought I had won this very serious competition, but I was disqualified by Aleksander, as the route and grade were scrutinised, evaluated and found to be too easy. The grade couldn't just involve the right number, it should be solely comprised of it. Period. To win the competition he resorted to the dirtiest trick in the book. He got me pregnant. Twice! He sent many 8- routes, and it was while losing my voice cheering him on that I realised I was not going to be better than him, nor anybody else. My goal will always be to become better than myself.

Two kids later my life suddenly revolved around being at home. Making routines and wonderful weekdays, between sleepless nights. I joined maternity bouldering sessions several times a week. The continuity helped. It's not like I was going anywhere, and I was motivated by the thought of being 42 years old and feeling stronger than ever. It was at that time that I realised the source of much of my motivation was to be found in progression, and that I was only just getting started. Even though I had been climbing for 25 years.

For Mother's Day I got the best present ever: five hours of coaching with Stian. My weaknesses weren't hard to uncover, all he had to do was place me in front of a bouldering wall. This became my focus – this and being less of a chatterbox when climbing. Stian put together a programme, which I mostly managed to follow for 12 weeks. It was surprisingly comfortable to know exactly what to do for every session. I didn't put in any more hours than before, but the results were noticeable.

Since then life has wandered hither and thither, as it does – and then came the pandemic.

But, this winter I'm going to use this book to write a plan. A 'training for climbing' plan, to give myself some out-of-this-world motivation. I want to play together with wonderful people, who can give me a kick in the butt and blow a sandy breeze my way when I need it. I want to go somewhere with them. Preferably to a crag where I can also swim and be so present I almost forget to pick the kids up from kindergarten.

Or at least forget to eat my sandwich.



Joakim Louis Sæther sends *Crassostrea Gigas* (F8b, trad), Bohuslän, Sweden.

INTRODUCTION

'IN THEORY THERE'S NO DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THEORY AND PRACTICE. IN PRACTICE THERE IS.'

AFTER TWO DECADES of climbing, training and coaching we have built up a large and ever-growing library of exercises. *The Climbing Bible*, first published in Norwegian in 2018 and English in 2020, was an extensive project

where we wanted to include the different performance factors and the underlying theory, which led to us having to limit the selection of exercises because of a lack of space. Therefore, in the backs of our minds we knew we had to also write the book you are now holding in your hands.

This book focuses on technique, strength and power, as we wanted to explore these topics further to create variation in and new challenges for your training. Endurance, flexibility and the mental aspects are left out as we feel these are explained in enough detail in *The Climbing Bible*. In this book, [chapter 1](#) describes exercises to improve anything from the precision of your footwork to long dynos, while [chapter 2](#) features exercises to train specific strength and power. We hope this book will end up with its pages filled with chalk marks and its cover worn out after living in your gym bag. Our recommendation is that you carry it with you and try at least one new exercise in every training session.

In addition to inspiring both young and old to vary their training, we wish to help parents and coaches create great sessions and make kids even more psyched for climbing. As Stian says, happiness is seeing your children find the same joy in climbing as you do yourself. [Chapter 3](#) therefore features games, technique exercises and physical training ideas for children.

THE 10 COMMANDMENTS OF CLIMBING

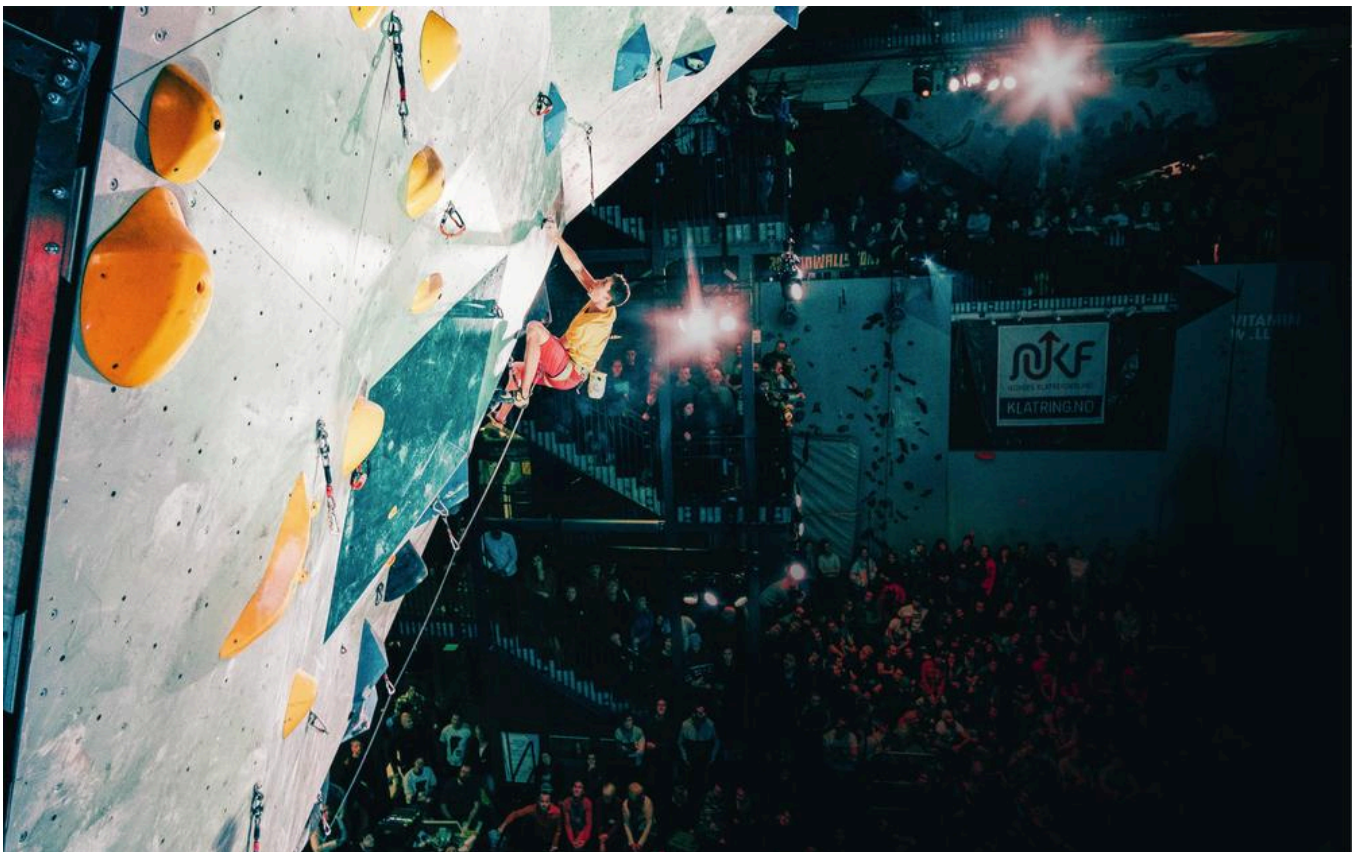


PHOTO: BJØRNAR SMESTAD

Stian Christophersen climbing in the 2019 National Lead finals in Oslo, Norway.

1. You have to climb a lot to become a good climber.
2. Vary your climbing between different styles and angles – both indoors and outdoors.
3. Train technique before physical training.
4. Learn to use your feet – they will be your best friends on the wall.
5. Rid yourself of your fear of falling.

6. Train finger strength.
7. Find your strengths and weaknesses, set yourself targets and adapt your training accordingly.
8. What and how you think is critical to your success – become just as strong mentally as you are physically and technically.
9. Create – or become part of – a supportive and challenging community.
10. Preserve the joy – climbing is all fun and games.